



IELTS Listening Practice Test

Transcript — Parts 1–4 · Episode 10

PART 1

You will hear a woman calling a canal boat rental company to make a booking. You now have some time to look at questions 1 to 10.

Speaker B: Welcome to Waterway Adventures. My name is Thomas, how can I help you today?

Speaker A: Hello, Thomas. My name is Sarah Harrison, and I'd like to book a canal boat holiday for this coming summer.

Speaker B: Certainly, Sarah. Let's get some details down first. I have your first name, but is your last name spelled H-A-R-R-I-S-O-N?

Speaker A: Yes, that is correct.

Speaker B: Thank you. And do you have a contact number we can reach you on?

Speaker A: Yes, it's 0-7-7-0-0-9-0-0-1-4-2.

Speaker B: Let me write that down: 0-7-7-0-0-9-0-0-1-4-2. Great. Now, when would you like the rental to start?

Speaker A: We'd like to set off on the 14th of July.

Speaker B: Perfect. We have a few different styles of canal boats. Were you looking at a specific one?

Speaker A: I saw one on your website called the Dragonfly. It looked very modern. Is that available?

Speaker B: Yes, the Dragonfly is available starting from that date. And how long would you like to rent it for?

Speaker A: Just for a week. We have to be back at work the following Monday.

Speaker B: Excellent, a one-week rental. How many people will be staying on the boat?

Speaker A: There will be four of us in total—myself, my husband, and our two teenage children.

Speaker B: Perfect, the Dragonfly sleeps up to six people, so four will be very comfortable. Now, our main base is in the town of Aldbury. Is that where you would like to



collect the boat from?

Speaker A: Yes, Aldbury is fine. How do you spell that?

Speaker B: It is spelled A-L-D-B-U-R-Y.

Speaker A: Got it, thank you.

Speaker B: Have you or your husband ever steered a canal boat before?

Speaker A: No, we have absolutely no experience. We are complete beginners.

Speaker B: Don't worry at all. We provide a full safety briefing and a hands-on tutorial before you set off.

Speaker A: That sounds reassuring.

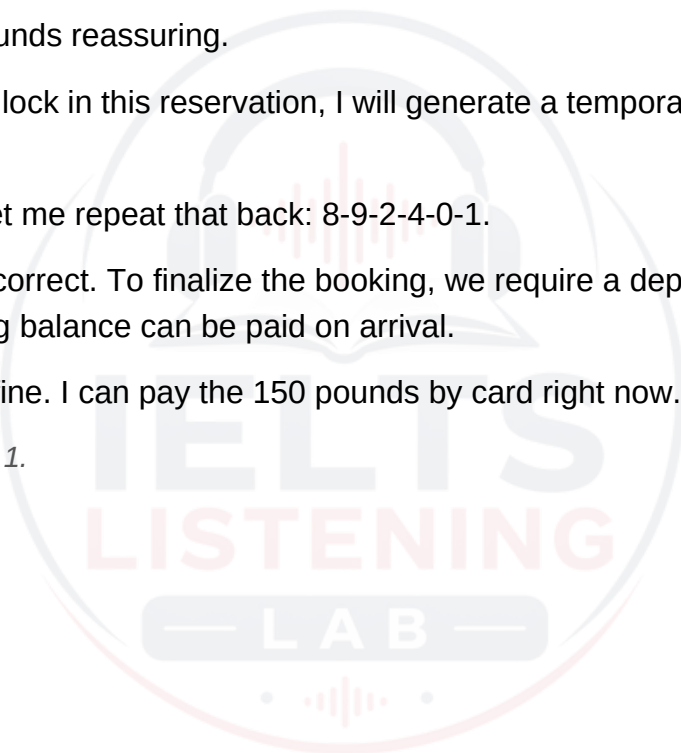
Speaker B: Now, to lock in this reservation, I will generate a temporary booking reference. It is 8-9-2-4-0-1.

Speaker A: Okay, let me repeat that back: 8-9-2-4-0-1.

Speaker B: That is correct. To finalize the booking, we require a deposit of 150 pounds today. The remaining balance can be paid on arrival.

Speaker A: That is fine. I can pay the 150 pounds by card right now.

This is the end of Part 1.



PART 2

You will hear a representative from Greenwood Wildlife Sanctuary talking about volunteer opportunities. You now have some time to look at questions 11 to 20.

Speaker A: Hello and welcome to the Greenwood Wildlife Sanctuary. My name is Clara, and I'm the volunteer coordinator here. It is wonderful to see so many people interested in helping us. Our main mission at Greenwood is to rescue and rehabilitate injured local animals, helping them return safely to the wild once they've recovered. While we do occasionally breed some rare native birds and run educational workshops for school groups, caring for injured wildlife remains our primary purpose.

Speaker A: We've recently decided to offer weekend volunteer shifts. In the past, we only ran weekday programs, but many people who work during the week expressed a desire to help out. So, we've opened up Saturdays and Sundays to accommodate their schedules. We hope this makes volunteering more accessible, even though our visitor numbers and feeding demands are steady throughout the week.

Speaker A: As a volunteer, you can work in different areas. In the public garden area, your main responsibility will be maintaining the visitor pathways to keep them safe and clear. You won't need to design new flower beds, and we already have a dedicated botanist who labels the plant species.

Speaker A: For those of you hoping to work directly in animal care, there are a few conditions. You don't need a biology degree, and you don't need a medical check, but we do ask for a reliable commitment. All animal-care volunteers must agree to stay with us for a minimum of six months so that the animals can get used to consistent handlers.

Speaker A: If you're ready to sign up for our upcoming orientation day, the process is very simple. We no longer take bookings over the phone or via email because it got too difficult to track. Instead, we have set up an online form on our website. Please use that to secure your spot.

Speaker A: Now, let's go over a few guidelines for your volunteer days. First, safety is our top priority, so you must wear strong boots to protect your feet from rough terrain and sharp tools. Normal sneakers or sandals are not allowed in the work zones. Next, because you'll be working outdoors, remember to bring a bottle to stay hydrated. We have fresh water refill stations located throughout the park.

Speaker A: There are also some great benefits to volunteering here. First, all active volunteers receive free entry to our highly anticipated annual festival, which takes place every autumn. In addition, you will get a fifteen percent discount at our partner outdoor shop in town. Finally, when you complete your time with us, you'll receive a beautiful



printed certificate that highlights your achievements, which is a great addition to any resume.

This is the end of Part 2.



PART 3

You will hear three students, Fiona, Emily, and Chloe, discussing their group presentation on green roofs. You now have some time to look at questions 21 to 30.

Speaker A: Hi Emily, hi Chloe. Thanks for meeting up today. We really need to finalize our presentation on green roofs before the weekend.

Speaker B: Hi Fiona. Yes, absolutely. I've been looking over our draft, and I think we have a solid outline, but there's still some work to do.

Speaker C: Hi guys. I agree. Fiona, what did you think of the introduction?

Speaker A: Well, I think we should actually rewrite it. Right now, it doesn't clearly state our main argument. It's got some great background information, but the audience might get lost before we even reach the main points.

Speaker B: That's a good point. We want to grab their attention immediately with our core thesis. I can help rephrase that. Now, what about the slide on the Tokyo case study? I was looking at it last night.

Speaker C: I thought the statistics on that slide were really interesting.

Speaker B: They are, but I feel like it's a bit text-heavy. I strongly suggest we replace some of those bullet points with a simple diagram. It would make the ecological benefits much easier for the class to visualize.

Speaker A: I love that idea, Emily. Visual aids are always better than wall-to-wall text. Let's do that.

Speaker C: While we're on the topic of research, I wanted to share what I found out about the installation costs. I was really surprised by the maintenance aspect. I expected the upkeep to stay expensive, but apparently, maintenance costs decrease significantly after five years once the plants are fully established.

Speaker B: Really? I would have thought the structural checks would keep costs high.

Speaker C: No, the plants become self-sustaining, which cuts down the gardening costs dramatically.

Speaker A: That's a great point to highlight. Now, let's make sure we are clear on the environmental benefits. We've listed carbon absorption, temperature reduction, and storm water management. What should we emphasize as the absolute biggest benefit?

Speaker C: Well, carbon dioxide absorption is important, but green roofs are relatively small compared to forests.

Speaker B: True. And while cooling down urban areas is great, urban planners are mostly excited about storm water run-off management. It prevents local sewer systems from overflowing during heavy rains.

Speaker A: I agree. That is definitely the most significant practical benefit, so let's make sure we emphasize that.

Speaker C: Okay, let's talk about the actual delivery of the presentation next Tuesday. How should we split the speaking roles?

Speaker B: Some groups have one main presenter, but I think our tutor prefers when we all speak.

Speaker A: Definitely. I think the fairest way is to take turns based on the sections we researched. That way, we are each speaking about the topics we know best.

Speaker C: That makes sense. It'll flow more naturally too.

Speaker B: Great, that's decided. Now, let's divide up the remaining preparation tasks. We still need to find some extra images for the slides.

Speaker A: I can do that. I know a couple of great open-source databases with high-res photos of urban architecture.

Speaker B: Perfect, thanks Fiona. What about the summary handout? We need to print that for the audience.

Speaker C: I've already drafted an outline for it. I don't mind taking charge of writing the full summary handout and polishing it.

Speaker B: Thanks, Chloe. We also have that short video clip showing the installation process. It needs some editing to fit our time limit.

Speaker A: I'm quite good with video editing software. I'll take care of editing the video clip tonight.

Speaker B: Excellent. I can format the reference list to make sure we follow the APA style guide correctly. It can be tedious, but I don't mind doing it.

Speaker C: That would be a huge help, Emily. And finally, we should probably email our tutor to see if she can give us some quick feedback on our slides before Tuesday.

Speaker B: I'm already in contact with her about another assignment, so it's probably best if I email the tutor for feedback. I'll send her our draft slide deck.

Speaker A: Sounds like a solid plan. Let's get to work!

This is the end of Part 3.

PART 4

*You will hear a history lecturer talking about the history and social impact of the fork in Europe.
You now have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.*

Speaker A: Good afternoon, everyone. My name is Marcus, and today we are going to explore the fascinating history of a common household object that we often take for granted: the dining fork. While today it is an indispensable part of our daily lives, its journey to the European dinner table was slow, controversial, and deeply tied to social status.

Speaker A: Let's start with its early history. In the ancient world, particularly in Greece and Rome, forks did exist, but they were not used for eating. Instead, they were used strictly as a cooking tool in kitchens, designed for lifting heavy meats out of boiling pots. These early forks were heavy, utilitarian objects, and they typically had only two prongs, which were forged from iron or bronze. Eating with one's hands was still the standard practice across all social classes.

Speaker A: The fork's introduction to Europe began in the 11th century. It is widely recorded that a Byzantine princess brought a set of gold forks with her when she traveled to Venice to marry a high-ranking Italian noble. When she used these forks at her wedding feast, the local guests were shocked. In fact, many people initially rejected the fork, viewing it as an insult to God, who they believed had given humans hands for the specific purpose of eating. When the princess fell ill and died shortly after, some religious leaders even declared it a divine punishment for her pride.

Speaker A: Despite this initial backlash, the fork slowly gained popularity among the Italian wealthy elite over the next few centuries. It was associated with extreme luxury and wealth, and these early forks were often beautifully crafted, made of silver or gold, and decorated with precious gemstones.

Speaker A: By the 17th century, the trend had spread to France. At the French court, the fork was commonly used to eat sticky fruit, such as preserved cherries or plums, in order to avoid staining one's elaborate lace cuffs. Around this time, the design of the fork began to evolve. Previously, forks had been straight and had only two or three prongs, which made them good for spearing food but poor for scooping it. German and French designers introduced a slight curve to the fork's body and added a fourth tine. This simple modification significantly improved the fork's usefulness, allowing diners to scoop up small grains and peas with ease.

Speaker A: However, forks remained a luxury item until the 19th century. The advent of the industrial revolution changed everything. New manufacturing techniques meant that

forks could be mass-produced quickly and cheaply. Instead of being handmade from precious metals, they were made using cast steel, which was durable, rust-resistant, and highly affordable for the general public.

Speaker A: This technological shift had a profound social impact. In the Victorian era, using a fork became a sign of good manners and refined taste among the growing middle class. Elaborate dining etiquette books were published, detailing exactly how and when to use different types of forks. Interestingly, the adoption of the fork also had a major health benefit. By reducing the direct hand-to-food contact during communal meals, it led to a dramatic decline in the transmission of certain diseases at the table, helping to improve public hygiene in crowded urban areas.

This is the end of Part 4.

